

Demonstration

Aims of a Demonstration

1. Highlight your product's key features and benefits in 10-12 minutes.
2. Answer the questions that your prospects or customers may have.

Structure



- Keep the overview very short
(e.g. “We will describe the main features,
show the hardware and demonstrate...”)

- repeat main feature
- invite questions

Introduction

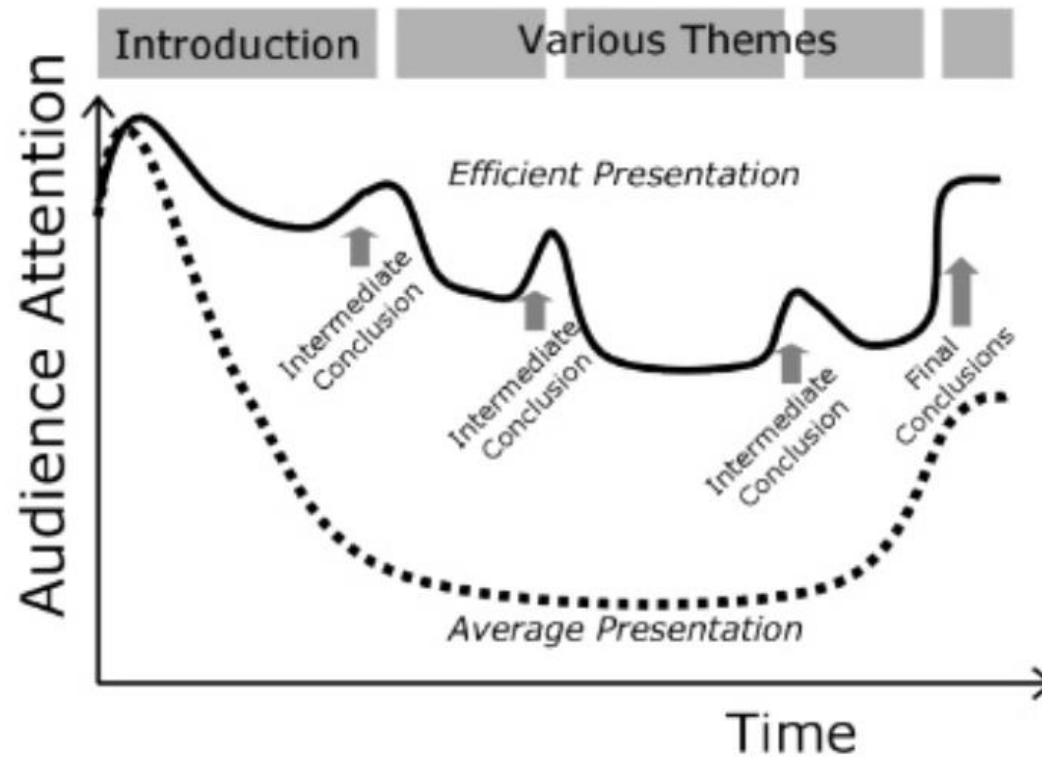
- Problem-solution structure
 - Briefly frame the issue.
 - Provide the solution and explain the benefits of it.



Conclusion

- Structure
 - Make it clear that the demonstration is over
 - Repeat key ideas and/or highlight benefits of your product
 - Invite questions

Structure: Signposting



Williams, Erica J. (2008): Presentations in English. Find your voice as a presenter, p.17.

Signposting: linking words

Beginning a new part

So, let's start with...

Moving on now to... / Now, let's move on to the second part of my talk.

This brings us to my next point. / The next issue/topic I'd like to focus on is...

I'd like to expand/elaborate on...

Let's take a look at... / Let's turn to ... now.

Going back

As I mentioned earlier, ... / As I've already explained, ... / As I said, ...

(→ see handout on the pool)

Demonstration



The first iPhone

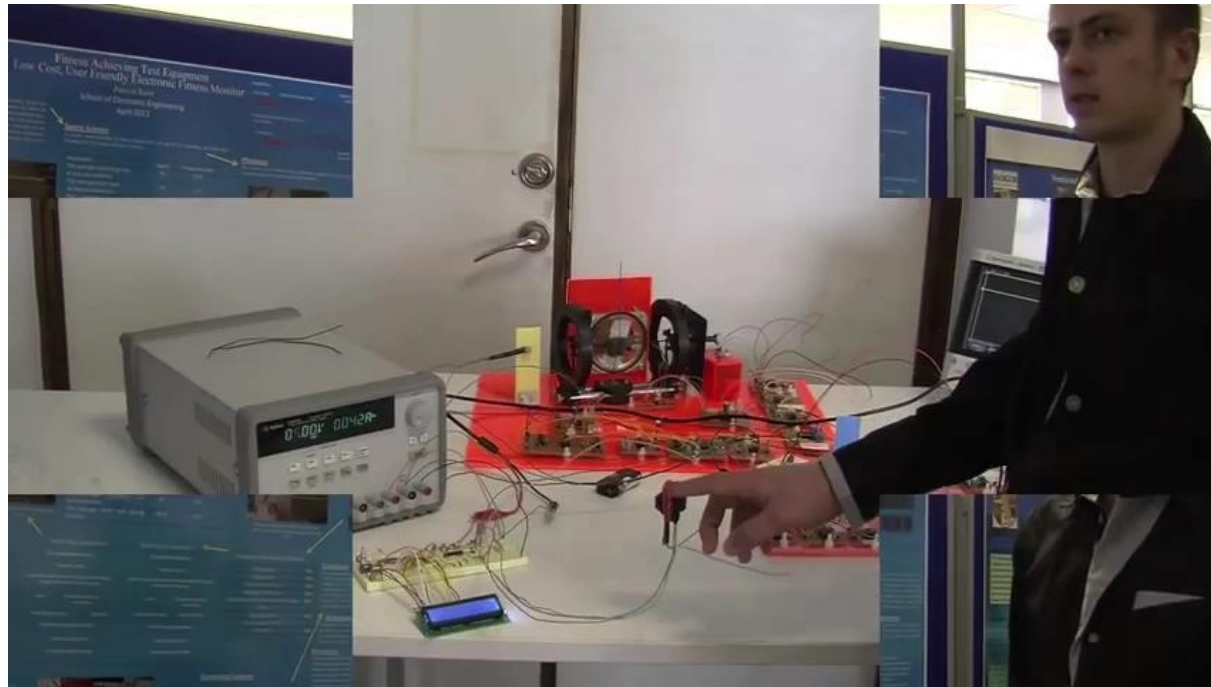
(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FjSpn-XDKBA>)

Demonstration



Demonstration

Example



(source: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JjVJgfTrLF8>)

Demonstration

Typical issues:

- basic features not demonstrated
- display not visible
- sound overlaps with talking
- issues ignored
- product manipulation not explained
- elements not ready

Demonstration: Tips

- Create a script for your demonstration (same as for video)
- Decide on who is going to demonstrate which part and use transitions («And now, Mr Müller will demonstrate....»)
- Make sure necessary details are visible (e.g. measurements on display)
- Remove any objects from the table that are not necessary for your demonstration (e.g. cables etc.)
- Use appropriate/formal terminology and provide specific facts/measurements («The distance measured is 5.4 m...»)

Demonstration: Tips

- Use assertive speech («The display shows...» or «The distance measured is...») and avoid relativising language («would», «could», «probably» etc.)
- Also point out main limitation(s) of the device
- If there's a feature that is not fully functional yet, show the current state of the feature (e.g. show voltage ramp needed for FMCW)
- Use only minimal aids (e.g. flipchart) that support your demonstration
- Practice demonstration as a group several times and put yourselves in the audience's shoes
- Use pointing device

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